Answers and talk notes

Understand Rates and Unit Rates

What your student is learning

Tonight we write each comparison as a fraction with the cost on top and the amount on the bottom, divide both parts by the bottom number to find the unit rate in fraction form over 1, and compare unit rates to pick the better value.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **C.** $20 / 5 tickets. The cost is on top and the tickets are on the bottom: $20 / 5 tickets.
2. **D.** $4. $24 ÷ 6 = $4 per visit.
3. **C.** 3. 12 ÷ 4 = 3, so the unit rate is 3 laps per minute.
4. **A.** $4.50. $18 ÷ 4 = $4.50 per gallon.
5. **B.** Theater B, because $4 is the lower rate. Theater B, because $4 is the lower rate per ticket, is the better value.
6. **C.** Plan X, $3 per gigabyte. Plan X is $30 ÷ 10 = $3 per gigabyte and Plan Y is $56 ÷ 14 = $4, so Plan X, $3 per gigabyte, is lower.

Talk about it

Which pass has the lower unit rate, and why does that make it the better value?

Home mission

Look at two snack packs at home. Read the price and the count on each. Can your student say the cost of ONE in each pack? Does the lower total always win?

When they are stuck, ask

- Which number goes on TOP of the fraction: the money or the amount?
- Now divide both parts by the bottom number. What is the unit rate over 1?
- State the unit rate in fraction form over 1 (like $5/1 item = $5 per item).

Try not to say

- Just pick the option with the smaller total price.
- The bigger package is always the better value.
- Divide only the top number without dividing the bottom.